

Ezras prayer.

Ezrá.

Strange mariage.

Exod. 23, 32.
& 34, 12, 15.
Deut. 7, 23.

Deut. 23, 5.

g Haft not
utterly cast vs
downe and de-
stroyed vs for
our finnes,
Deu. 28, 13.

h He sheweth
that God is
iuste in pu-
nishing his
people, & yet
merciful in re-
serving a re-
sidue to who-
me he sheweth
fauour.

3. Esdr. 8, 92.
a He confes-
sed his finnes
and the finnes
of the people.

b Meaning,
what God wol-
de receiue the
so mercie.

c Which are
strangers and
married con-
trarie to the
Law of God.

d Because God
hath giuen
thee authori-
tie, & learning
to perswade
people herein
and to coman-
de them.

3. Esdr. 9, 1.

11 Which thou hast commanded by thy seruants the Prophetes, saying, * The lād whereunto ye go to possesse it, is an vn-cleane land, because of the filthines of the people of the lands, which by their abominaciōs, and by their vncleannes haue filled it from corner to corner.

12 Now therefore shal ye not giue your daughters vnto their sonnes, nether shal ye take their daughters vnto your sonnes, nor seke their * peace nor wealth for euer, that ye may be strōg and eat the goodnes of the land, and leaue it for an inheritance to your sonnes for euer.

13 And after all that is come vpon vs for our euil dedes, and for our great trespasses (seing that thou our God hast staied vs from being benethe s for our iniquities, & hast giuen vs suche deliuerance)

14 Shulde we returne to breake thy cōmandements, and ioine in affinitie with the people of suche abominaciōs? woldest not thou be angrie toward vs til thou haddest cōsumed vs, so that there shulde be no remnant nor anie eskaping?

15 O Lord God of Israēl, thou art iuste, for we haue bene h referued to escape, as appeareth this day: beholde, we are before thee in our trespasses: therefore we cannot stand before thee because of it.

C H A P. X.

1 The people repent and turne, and put away their strange wiues.

1 W Hiles * Ezrá prayed thus, & a confessed him selfe weping, and falling downe before y house of God, there assembled vnto him of Israēl a very great Congregation of men and women & children: for the people wept with a great lamentacion.

2 Then Shechaniáh the sonne of Iehiél one of the sonnes of Elám, answered, and said to Ezrá, We haue trespassed against our God, and haue taken strange wiues of the people of the land, yet now there is b hope in Israēl concerning this.

3 Now therefore let vs make a couenant with our God, to put away c all the wiues (and suche as are borne of them) according to the counsel of the Lord, and of those that feare the commandements of our God, and let it be done according to the Law.

4 Arise: for the matter d belongeth vnto thee: we also wil be with thee: be of comforte and do it.

5 ¶ Then arose Ezrá, and caused the chief Priests, the Leuites, & all Israēl, to sweare that they wolde do according to this worde. So they sware.

6 * And Ezrá rose vp from before the house of God, and went into the chambre of Io-

hanán the sonne of Eliašhib: he went euen thither, but he did eat nether bread, nor dronke water: for he mourned, because of the trasgression of the of the captiuitie.

7 And they caused a proclamacion to go throughout Iudáh and Ierusalém, vnto * all them of the captiuitie, that they shulde assemble them selues vnto Ierusalém.

8 And whosoever wolde not come within thre dayes according to the counsel of the princes and Elders, all his substance shulde be e forfaiť, & he shulde be separate from the Congregation of them of the captiuitie.

9 ¶ Then all the men of Iudáh & Beniamín assembled them selues vnto Ierusalém within thre dayes, which was the twētieth day of the e ninte moneth, and all the people sate in the strete of the house of God, trembling for this matter, and for the f raine.

10 And Ezrá the Priest stode vp, and said vnto them, Ye haue transgressed, and haue taken strange wiues, to s increase the trespassse of Israēl.

11 Now therefore h giue praise vnto the Lord God of your fathers, and do his wil and separate your selues from the people of the land, & from the strange wiues.

12 And all the Congregation answered, & said with a loude voyce, So wil we do according to thy wordes vnto vs.

13 But the people are many, and it is a raynie wether, and we are not able to stand without, neither is it the worke of one day or two: for we are many that haue offended in this thing.

14 Let our rulers stand therefore i before all the Congregation, and let all them which haue taken strange wiues in our cities, come at the time appointed, and with them the Elders of euerie citie and the iudges thereof, til the fierce wrath of our God for this matter turne away from vs.

15 Then were appointed Ionathán the sonne of Asah-él, and Lahaziáh the sonne of Tikuáh ouer this matter, and Meshullám and Shabbethái the Leuites helped them.

16 And thei of the captiuitie did so, and k departed, euen Ezrá the Priest, & the mē that were chief fathers to the familie of their fathers by name, and sate downe in the first daye of the tentē moneth to examine the matter.

17 And vntil the first day of y first moneth they were finishing the busines with all the men that had taken strange wiues,

18 And of the sonnes of the Priests there were men founde, that had taken strange wiues, to wit, of the sonnes of Ieshúa, the sonne of Iozadák, & of his brethren, Maaseiáh, A Eliézer, and Iarib and Gedaliáh.

19 And thei gaue l their hāds, that thei wolde

* Ezr. sonne of the captiuitie.

* Or, seldom.

e Which contained part of Nouember & part of Decem-ber.

f For the season was giuen to raine, & so y wether was more sharpe & colde, and also their conscience troubled them.

g Ye haue layed one sinne vpon another.

h Read 10th.

7, 19.

i Let them be appointed to examine this matter.

k Thei went to the chief ci-ries to sit on this matter w was thre moneths in finishing.

l As a token that thei wolde kepe promes & do it.